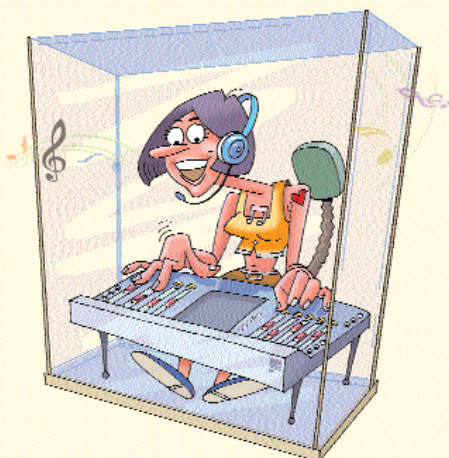




BROADCAST: A RADIO STATION OF YOUR OWN

Internet radio works on the simple premise that you play your music. Start a channel, sell it to your friends, and fight back against the networks that've been strangulating you with boybands and all that mellow nonsense. All it takes is a little know-how, a decent soundcard and some basic encoding software that you can get for free

Keeping it Real

Get a copy of RealProducer Basic from RealNetworks.com. The Basic version is free.

Open RealProducer and click New Session. A wizard will pop up. Click Record from file and hit OK.

Select Capture Audio and

click Next. Give your set a name and click Next.

Choose either Multi-rate stream or Single-rate stream, depending on your server, and click Next. Select your target audience and click Next. Select Music (higher quality, but mono) or Stereo Music (lower quality, but

stereo) and click Next. Click Finish. Begin recording by clicking the Start button.

Now all you have to do is find a service such as Groovefactory, or create your own server that will host the files.

SHOUTcast

Nullsoft's SHOUTcast is a streaming audio system designed to work across all platforms. At the heart of SHOUTcast is the DNAS (the distributed network audio server). When you setup a SHOUTcast server the DNAS accepts the audio stream from Winamp and the SHOUTcast DSP plugin. It then delivers it to listeners who are connected to this DNAS. In this set up, you could either be a listener, source provider, or a server.

Listening to streaming radio

Start an instance of Winamp. Visit www.shoutcast.com, www.live365.com, or www.icecast.org. Select your music category from the choices available. Click on the Tune icon and the

stream automatically starts with your MP3 player (usually Winamp). No special installations are required.

Source provider

You can be a music source provider and any DNAS could listen to you. You could use Winamp as your music player. A SHOUTcast source plugin (this can be downloaded from www.shoutcast.com) needs to be installed for your Winamp. This plugin provides Winamp with broadcasting abilities and you are now ready to stream your music. Remember, to enable others to listen to what you play, you need to have a DNAS.

Time to server

Download the SHOUTcast server software from the site and install it. Start the DNAS GUI. Open the configuration file by clicking on the Edit Config option from the menu bar. This opens the configuration script in a default viewer (usually Notepad). Every entry has an easy-to-follow remark along side. Set the maximum user limit taking your bandwidth into account.

If you know a little about IP and networks, you can mess around with the SrcIP and DestIP (source and destination IP). If not, leave them at their defaults. Now you are ready to listen from a source and stream it across to users connected to the DNAS of your SHOUTcast server.

You can be both, the service provider and the server. You can set up both the services in the same computer or, depending upon your resource availability, you can set a couple of computers as servers and a single computer as a server listening from all the service providers.

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Streamripping: Recording Live



If you would like to make a live recording of all the tunes on the Web, a straightforward approach to

this is the disk writer plugin of Winamp. It writes a WAV file at the time of capture from the relay. This direct approach requires more work and disk space, and some editing with a wave editor such as SoundForge or CoolEdit. A faster way to do this is StreamRipper, which creates MP3s out of streaming radio. You can obtain StreamRipper32 from www.oddsock.org/tools/sripper.

StreamRipper32 does not

create any desktop icons or start menu items. So go to the folder and run an instance of the program. On the top left, under



Streamripper snags an MP3 from SHOUTcast live

Broadcast Parameters, you will need to enter the full URL of the stream.

Under the Output Section, you will need to select a Destination Directory.

StreamRipper32 will create a number of sub-directories and delete and move files on its own. It will be limited by the permissions you have on the parent directory. You can enter a number in the Max Bytes to Rip field to control when to stop recording, but the default value of zero will allow it to run until you either run out of disk or click the Stop Rip button.

Click the Start Rip button and let StreamRipper do its thing.